

Pre-built images

For those who don't want to go through the entire procedure mentioned above, there is a short-cut—download a pre-built image made by someone else, and test it in VirtualBox. I recommend that you download pre-built images from:

- <http://tabletsx86.org/x86-UPDATED-BUILDS.htm>
 - <http://www.android-x86.org/download>
- Android x86 4.0 RC1, released by the Android-x86 team, is based on Android 4.0.3 ICS, and has the following features:
- Support for multi-touch, Wi-Fi, audio, Bluetooth, G-sensor and camera
 - OpenGL hardware acceleration for AMD Radeon and Intel chipsets
 - Linux Kernel 3.0.8 with KMS enabled; most netbooks can run Android-x86 in the native resolution.
 - V8 JavaScript engine
 - Can simulate an SD card with internal storage
 - External USB drive and SD card are auto mounted to /mnt/USB on plugging
 - Experimental support of Renderscript
 - A text-based GUI installer which supports ext3/ext2/ntfs/fat32 file-systems
 - Hybrid ISO (you can dump the ISO into a USB drive using `'dd if=android-x86-4.0-xxx.iso of=/dev/sd'`)
- When you build an Android image from source, a lot

of things won't work out-of-the-box as you would expect. You need to install patches to rectify this, or find a pre-built Android image. When I built the above image, I could not get the Internet to work on it.

To build Android 2.3 and older, you need to have a 64-bit machine. For earlier versions, a 32-bit machine is recommended. 

Links

[1] <http://www.android-x86.org/>

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The author is a FOSS advocate and loves to explore different open source technologies. His areas of interest include OpenCV, Python, Android, Linux, Arduino, BeagleBoard and other open source hardware platforms. In his spare time, he likes to make video tutorials on various different open source technologies, which can be found on YouTube. He is a big time Arsenal fan. He can be reached at jayneil.dalal@gmail.com.



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